



Finding a Gap in the Market

For your business to succeed there must be a market—or potential to create one—for what you plan to offer. This means either selling something entirely new that people will want or providing a better alternative to what is available.

Identifying gaps

A gap in the market is simply a need that is not currently met. This is either because the product or service to meet that need does not yet exist, because existing businesses fail to meet it adequately, or because the need has not yet been identified. For example, while a town may have several restaurants, it may lack one serving Mexican cuisine, which is a need you could address. Alternatively, the town may have a French restaurant that fails to meet customer needs by not catering for children, which is also a potential gap.

Finally, while the town's residents may feel content with the existing restaurants, they may still eagerly adopt a completely new alternative approach that meets a need they did not know they had. For instance, a food delivery service that allows them to order any cuisine, at any time, to enjoy at home.

In order to find a gap, research the market you are planning to enter, and think about your own experiences (see pp.16–17). Look for products and services that are not currently available, which you could offer. Also look at those that are available to



Filling the gap

A gap in the market is a chance to reach an untapped group of customers. A portion of an existing market may be underserved or a new opportunity may appear within an existing industry. By studying trends and what competitors offer, you can assess whether your product could fulfil customer needs that are not currently met.

